

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 27

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1. Antagonize

Meaning: To annoy, oppose, or make someone hostile.

Tip to remember: Antagonize comes from antagonist, the opponent in a story. If you antagonize someone, you make them your opponent.

Sentence: His rude comments antagonized the entire team.

2. Barren

Meaning: Unable to produce plants, fruit, or useful results; empty.

Tip to remember: Think of a dry desert with no plants. That land is barren.

Sentence: The discussion was barren of new ideas.

3. Bombastic

Meaning: Using language that sounds impressive but has little real meaning.

Tip to remember: Bombastic sounds like a bomb: loud and dramatic. Bombastic speech is loud and inflated.

Sentence: The leader's bombastic speech impressed few serious listeners.

4. Cajole

Meaning: To persuade someone by flattery or gentle pressure.

Tip to remember: Think of saying sweet words to convince someone. That is cajoling.

Sentence: She tried to cajole her friend into joining the club.

5. Chary

Meaning: Cautious, careful, or unwilling to take risks.

Tip to remember: Chary sounds like "carey." A chary person is very careful.

Sentence: Investors became chary after the market crash.

6. Curmudgeon

Meaning: A bad-tempered, difficult, or complaining person.

Tip to remember: Think of an old man always grumbling about everything. That person is a curmudgeon.

Sentence: The curmudgeon complained about the noise every evening.

7. Dirge

Meaning: A sad song or poem, especially for the dead.

Tip to remember: Dirge sounds heavy and sad, like a funeral song.

Sentence: The mourners sang a dirge at the funeral.

8. **Estimable**

Meaning: Worthy of respect and admiration.

Tip to remember: Estimable sounds like “esteem.” If someone is estimable, you hold them in high esteem.

Sentence: The estimable professor was respected by all his students.

9. **Euphemism**

Meaning: A mild or indirect expression used instead of a harsh or unpleasant one.

Tip to remember: Think of saying “passed away” instead of “died.” That is a euphemism.

Sentence: “Let go” is often used as a euphemism for being fired.

10. **Excoriate**

Meaning: To criticize very severely.

Tip to remember: Excoriate sounds like “scrape the skin off.” Harsh criticism can feel like being scraped.

Sentence: The reviewer excoriated the poorly written report.

11. **Exigent**

Meaning: Urgent and demanding immediate attention.

Tip to remember: Exigent sounds like “emergency urgent.” An exigent situation needs quick action.

Sentence: The hospital gave priority to exigent cases.

12. **Haughty**

Meaning: Arrogant and looking down on others.

Tip to remember: Haughty sounds like “high.” A haughty person acts as if they are above everyone else.

Sentence: His haughty attitude made him unpopular.

13. **Heady**

Meaning: Exciting, intoxicating, or making one feel confident and bold.

Tip to remember: Heady goes to your head, like success or excitement.

Sentence: The heady success of the startup attracted many investors.

14. **Imperturbable**

Meaning: Calm and not easily upset or disturbed.

Tip to remember: Perturb means disturb. Imperturbable means not able to be disturbed.

Sentence: The pilot remained imperturbable during the emergency.

15. **Implacable**

Meaning: Impossible to calm, satisfy, or stop.

Tip to remember: Placate means calm. Implacable means cannot be placated or

calmed.

Sentence: The two sides were implacable enemies.

16. **Lambaste**

Meaning: To criticize harshly or attack verbally.

Tip to remember: Lambaste sounds like “blast.” If you lambaste someone, you blast them with criticism.

Sentence: The journalist lambasted the corrupt officials.

17. **Miscreant**

Meaning: A person who behaves badly or breaks the law.

Tip to remember: Miscreant contains “mis,” meaning wrong. A miscreant does wrong things.

Sentence: The miscreant was caught stealing from the shop.

18. **Peccadillo**

Meaning: A small mistake or minor fault.

Tip to remember: Think of a tiny sin. A peccadillo is not a huge crime, just a small fault.

Sentence: Forgetting to say thank you was only a peccadillo.

19. **Philistine**

Meaning: A person who lacks appreciation for art, culture, or intellectual things.

Tip to remember: Think of someone who calls every painting useless. That person is a philistine.

Sentence: He dismissed poetry as a waste of time, sounding like a philistine.

20. **Relegate**

Meaning: To send or assign to a lower position or rank.

Tip to remember: Think of a football team being relegated to a lower league.

Sentence: The manager relegated him to a minor role in the project.

21. **Repugnant**

Meaning: Extremely unpleasant, offensive, or disgusting.

Tip to remember: Repugnant sounds like “repel.” Something repugnant pushes you away because it is disgusting.

Sentence: The idea of cheating was repugnant to her.

22. **Sentimental**

Meaning: Strongly influenced by emotions, especially tender or nostalgic feelings.

Tip to remember: Sentimental comes from sentiment, meaning feeling.

Sentence: He kept the old notebook for sentimental reasons.

23. **Squander**

Meaning: To waste money, time, or opportunity.

Tip to remember: Think of throwing coins into water for no reason. That is squandering money.

Sentence: He squandered his vacation by scrolling on his phone all day.

24. **Swindle**
Meaning: To cheat someone out of money or property.
Tip to remember: Swindle sounds like “scam.” A swindler scams people.
Sentence: The fake agent swindled students by promising scholarships.
25. **Tangible**
Meaning: Real and able to be touched; clear and definite.
Tip to remember: Tangible sounds like “touchable.” Tangible results can be seen or felt.
Sentence: The project produced tangible benefits for the community.
26. **Turpitude**
Meaning: Moral corruption or wickedness.
Tip to remember: Think of a person with a dirty moral attitude. Turpitude means deep moral badness.
Sentence: The official’s bribery revealed his moral turpitude.
27. **Unalloyed**
Meaning: Pure and not mixed with anything else.
Tip to remember: An alloy is a mixture of metals. Unalloyed means not mixed, therefore pure.
Sentence: Her success brought unalloyed joy to her family.
28. **Undercut**
Meaning: To weaken, damage, or reduce the effectiveness of something.
Tip to remember: Think of cutting under a tree. The tree becomes weak from below.
Sentence: The contradictory evidence undercut his argument.
29. **Wheedle**
Meaning: To persuade someone by flattery or coaxing.
Tip to remember: Wheedle sounds like “sweet deal.” You use sweet words to get a deal.
Sentence: The child tried to wheedle extra pocket money from his parents.
30. **Xenophobic**
Meaning: Fearful or hateful toward foreigners or people from other cultures.
Tip to remember: “Xeno” means foreign, and “phobic” means fearful. Xenophobic means fear or hatred of foreigners.
Sentence: The leader’s xenophobic remarks were widely criticized.